How to say how long you have been doing something using the word "DEPUIS"

- We know that the **present tense is used to describe**:

  - **What you are doing** *(I am eating)*
  - **What you normally do** *(I eat)*
  - **What you have been doing/have done for some time**
    (I have been eating for…. I have eaten for…)

- In order for the present tense to convey an **action which began in the past but is still going on**, it needs to be used with the word "*depuis*". This word alone changes the meaning of the present tense.

  J'écoute le professeur.
  This means either "now" or "normally"
  J'écoute le professeur DEPUIS 10 minutes.
  This means that you have listened/been listening for 10 minutes.
  The action began in the past but is still going on, i.e. in the present tense.

- *DEPUIS* is used in the same place as the English would use "*for*", i.e "*je verbe depuis 2 heures*". **Another way to convey the same idea**, is to put "*cela fait…que*" or "*il y a…que*" before the length of time, followed by the verb, i.e. "*cela fait deux heures que je verbe*" or "*il y a deux heures que je verbe*"

  - *j'apprends le français depuis cinq ans*
    je suis ici depuis une semaine
  - *cela fait cinq ans que j'apprends le français*
    cela fait une semaine que je suis ici
  - *il y a cinq ans que j'apprends le français*
    il y a une semaine que je suis ici

- **To ask someone how long** they have been doing something you can say either "*Depuis combien de temps est-ce que…*" or " *Depuis combien de temps + inversion*".

  - Depuis combien de temps apprends-tu le français?
  - Depuis combien de temps est-ce que tu apprends le français?

You must now complete the yellow Pre-Test Exercises at the back of this booklet: your teacher will check you have done them and review the answers with you before your test in div. Don't leave blanks: consult the pamphlet as you do them.

Regular -IR Verbs in the present tense

- **Remove the infinitive ending** IR (fin~~ir~~, réuss~~ir~~, vieill~~ir~~)
- You are left with the "stem". **Add the personal ending to the stem**
  1. je FIN – **is**
  2. tu FIN – **is**
  3. il/elle FIN – **it**
  4. nous FIN – **issons**
  5. vous FIN – **issez**
  6. ils FIN – **issent**

Some other **very** common verbs which follow this pattern are:

bâtir	*to build*	**choisir**	*to choose*
démolir	*to demolish*	**grandir**	*to grow older/bigger*
punir	*to punish*	**réfléchir**	*to think/reflect*
remplir	*to fill (up)*	**réussir**	*to manage/succeed*
rougir	*to blush*	**saisir**	*to grab/snatch*
vieillir	*to grow old*	**agrandir**	*to enlarge*
applaudir	*to clap*	**atterrir**	*to land*

Irregular –IR verbs in the present tense

- **First 3 or 4 letter stem verbs**: have the first three or four three letters of the –IR infinitive as a stem and add the endings **–s,-s,-t,-ons,-ez,-ent.**

  - *dormir*, *mentir*, *partir*, *sentir*, *sortir*

  - *je D^{1}O^{2}R^{3}s* *nous D^{1}O^{2}R^{3}M^{4}ons*
  - *tu MENs* *vous MENTez*
  - *il PARt* *ils PARTent*

- -**IR verbs using –ER endings**. Simply treat them as if they were –ER verbs.
  - *couvrir*, *découvrir*, *offrir*, *ouvrir*, *souffrir*

  - *je COUVRe* *nous OUVRons*
  - *tu DÉCOUVRes* *vous SOUFFrez*
  - *il OFFRe* *ils COUVRent*

- **MOURIR**: *je meurs*, *tu meurs*, *il meurt*, *nous MOURons*, *vous MOURez*, *ils meurent*

- **VENIR**: *je viens*, *tu viens*, *il vient*, *nous VENons*, *vous VENez*, *ils viennent*

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